SkillNavora

MODULE 23 HANDBOOK

Module 23: SFMC Architecture and Enterprise Implementation

5 sections, 32 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 23: SFMC Architecture and Enterprise Implementation

Level: Advanced. Architecture decisions for multi-business-unit programmes and how to document them.

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Detailed lessons

Module 23

23.1 Multi-business-unit architecture

WHAT IS IT?

> Decide what is shared at parent level (footers, compliance text, reference data) and what is isolated per business unit (sender, subscribers, data). Document each decision.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Architecture choices decide governance, cost and how easily brands can change.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Write requirements (functional and non-functional).
2. Draw the business unit and data diagram.
3. Record decisions as ADRs.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Shared reference data at parent; brand subscribers isolated in child business units.

COMMON ERRORS

Sharing subscriber data across brands without a legal basis.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Design a multi-business-unit SFMC solution.

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a one-page architecture for two brands with one shared footer library.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- C4 model (diagrams)

23.1 Solution Architecture: every topic explained

SFMC architecture. How SFMC is set up for a customer.

Enterprise architecture. How SFMC fits with CRM, data and other systems.

Business unit strategy. Plan for business units.

Data architecture. Plan for data and keys.

Integration architecture. Plan for APIs, files and connectors.

Security architecture. Plan for access and data protection.

23.2 Enterprise Implementation: every topic explained

Requirement discovery. Interviews and workshops to learn needs.

Business process mapping. Mapping current processes.

Technical requirements. Systems, data and performance needs.

Functional requirements. What the solution must do.

Non-functional requirements. Security, performance and availability needs.

Solution design. The design document.

Implementation planning. Plan, phases and resources.

23.3 Multi-Business-Unit Architecture: every topic explained

Parent-child business units. Parent and child units and what is shared.

Shared data extensions. Shared tables across units.

Shared assets. Shared content across units.

Business unit governance. Rules for each unit.

Data isolation. Keeping each unit's data separate.

Centralised versus decentralised architecture. Central control versus local teams.

23.4 Technical Documentation: every topic explained

Architecture diagrams. Diagrams of components.

Data flow diagrams. Diagrams of data movement.

Integration specifications. Specs for each integration.

Data mapping documents. Field-level mapping between systems.

Solution design documents. The full design document.

Technical runbooks. Step-by-step operational guides.

23.5 Deployment and Change Management: every topic explained

Development and testing. Build and test in a test business unit or sandbox.

UAT. User acceptance testing with the business.

Production release. Planned release to production.

Asset migration. Moving assets between business units or accounts with packages or tools.

Configuration management. Recording configuration.

Release validation. Checking after release.

Rollback planning. Plan to undo a release.